

1 Pronunciations of the Number 0 in English

The digit 0 has multiple names depending on context and region.

1.1 Summary Table

Term	Pronunciation	Main Contexts
Zero	<i>z.ro</i> (AmE)	Math, science, temperatures, general standalone
Oh	<i>o</i>	Phone numbers, addresses, years, codes
Nought	<i>nt</i>	Decimals (BrE), archaic
Nil	<i>nl</i>	Soccer/football scores (UK/Commonwealth)
Love	<i>lv</i>	Tennis scores
Nothing	<i>n.ŋ</i>	Sports scores (esp. AmE baseball/football)
Null	<i>nl</i>	Computing/databases

Term	Examples
Zero	"Zero degrees", " $2 + 0 = 2$ "
Oh	"555-1204" → "... one two oh four" "1905" → "nineteen oh five"
Nought	"0.75" → "nought point seven five"
Nil	"3-0" → "three-nil"
Love	"15-0" → "fifteen-love"
Nothing	"3-0" → "three to nothing"
Null	"Null value"

Term	Notes/Regions
Zero	Precise; avoids confusion with letter O
Oh	Rhythmic; common in spoken English (esp. AmE)
Nought	Preferred in BrE; rare in AmE
Nil	Formal "nothing"; also medical use
Love	Tennis-specific tradition
Nothing	Informal emphasis on absence
Null	Technical; means absent

1.2 Informal/Slang Terms

- zilch, zip, nada, goose egg (general zero)
- duck (cricket score of 0)

1.3 Quick Guidelines

- **Oh**: for digit strings (rhythm).
- **Zero**: for clarity/precision.
- BrE favors **nought** and **nil**; AmE favors **zero**, **oh**, **nothing**.
- Domain-specific terms (love, nil, nothing, null) are fixed by tradition.